Feiyang Liu

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Research Interests

Language-Centric Multimodal Systems: Scalable, Unified, and Controllable Multimodal Models; Unified Multimodal Pretraining; Solving Vision Problems with LLMs; Symbolic Vision; End-to-End Multimodal Training Systems.

Education

South China University of Technology Sep 2022 – Jun 2027 (expected)
B.Eng. in Intelligent Science and Technology

University of California, Berkeley Aug 2024 – May 2025
Visiting Student

Publications

1. Haoquan Zhang, **Feiyang Liu**, Juanxi Tian, Wanhua Li, Haodong Duan, Weiyang Liu. **PixelBench: Can LLMs Understand and Generate Images Pixel by Pixel?** 2026. [Project]
2. Qinzheng Zhou, **Feiyang Liu**, Lijing Lu, Zhihang Li. **Confidence-Guided Multi-Scale Aggregation for Sparse-View High-Resolution 3D Gaussian Splatting.** *CVPR 2026*, **Highlight**. [Paper]
3. Qinzheng Zhou, **Feiyang Liu**, Lijing Lu, Zhihang Li. **Commit Only When Justified: Counterfactual Topology Selection for Sparse-View 3DGS.** Under review (Phase 2), *AAAI 2027*.

Research Experience

OpenUMM: Demystifying the Design Space of Unified Multimodal Models Ongoing
Project Lead; UC Santa Cruz and Gemini Team

- Leading an end-to-end empirical study (in the spirit of *Towards Physics of Multimodal Pretraining* and *Beyond Language Modeling*) of unified language modeling, visual understanding, and image generation (Qwen3 + flow matching) with a major focus on **large-scale pretraining**, ablating **tokenizers/encoders**, **architecture/MoT routing**, **data mixtures/resolution**, and **cross-task synergy**.
- Investigating **multi-stage pretraining and post-training recipes** (warm-up, module learning rates, text replay, loss weighting) and **performance prediction**, correlating pretraining signals and short probes with post-training outcomes.
- Built and optimized a modular JAX/Flax pretraining, post-training, and decontaminated evaluation stack across **hundreds of TPU v5p/v6e chips** (multi-host/multi-slice sharding, ZeRO-1, rematerialization, elastic recovery, XLA profiling).

GroundingBench Ongoing
Research Contributor; CUHK and ByteDance Seed

- Investigating whether modern LLMs can directly replace specialist and generative vision models on standard computer vision tasks, in contrast to approaches that repurpose image or video generation models for visual perception (e.g., Vision Banana, GenCeption, and SenseNova-Vision).
- Responsible for a subset of 2D visual tasks (including object detection and counting): curating and verifying training and evaluation data, defining evaluation protocols, and tuning and evaluating baseline models.

PixelBench
Research Contributor; CUHK and ByteDance Seed

- Probed LLMs as general visual generators without agentic tools, visual tokenizers, or diffusion modules, generating pixel images, 3D voxels, and video in text as **symbolic visual primitives** and scaling with coding/reasoning ability.
- Co-developed **Pixel Reconstruction Tuning (PRT)** in pretraining/post-training using text-encoded pixels to boost visual understanding; analyzed visual abstraction (downsampling, resolution) and built the workbench.

Sparse-View 3D Reconstruction 2025 – 2026
Research Collaborator; Huazhong University of Science and Technology

- Designed confidence-guided multi-scale aggregation and counterfactual topology selection algorithms to mitigate high-frequency floaters and premature topological lock-in in sparse-view 3D Gaussian Splatting.

Technical Skills

- **ML Systems:** JAX/Flax, PyTorch, multi-host/multi-slice TPU training, sharding, ZeRO-1, XLA profiling.
- **Graphics & 3D:** C++ graphics programming, path tracing, mesh processing, physical simulation, 3DGS; Three.js / React Three Fiber, Blender, OpenGL/GLSL, Unity.
- **Programming:** Python, C/C++, Java.